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HMRC STAFF HOLD CLASS ON 'GUILT OF BEING BRITISH'

Kemi leads backlash over tax officials' 'nonsense' seminar during office hours

CIVIL servants working for the taxman were criticised last night for holding a seminar on the 'Guilt of being British'.

HM Revenue and Customs staff were able to log into the online session during office hours yesterday, prompting a

EXCLUSIVE

By **Ryan Hooper** and **Charlotte Gill**

furious backlash, with Tory leader Kemi Badenoch describing it as 'nonsense'.

It follows repeated criticism of HMRC's performance after hundreds of thousands of calls from

taxpayers went unanswered every month, customers were cut off abruptly and MPs voiced concerns about its 'failing' phone service.

Mrs Badenoch said Whitehall aides should leave the Civil Service if they were not proud of Britain, while an HMRC insider said the session was an 'abandonment of Civil Service neutrality'. Mrs

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